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GULF NEWS



ENTERTAINMENT | P15

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THE VIEWS | P8

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INDIA | P11

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PRESIDENT CONFERS ZAYED MEDAL UPON GUINEA-BISSAU LEADER

President His Highness Shaikh Mohammad Bin Zayed Al Nahyan confers the prestigious Order of Zayed upon Guinea-Bissau President Umaro Sissoco Embalo in recognition of his efforts in strengthening ties between the two countries, at Qasr Al Shati in Abu Dhabi yesterday. President Embalo conferred the Amílcar-Cabral Medal, the highest honour awarded by the West African country, upon Shaikh Mohammad in recognition of his outstanding efforts in strengthening bilateral relations across various fields.

Corporate tax stimulus for multinationals

UAE clarifies on domestic minimum top-up tax

DUBAI
BY MANOJ NAIR
Business Editor

The UAE has confirmed new tax incentives for subsidiaries of multinational companies (MNCs), effective January 1, 2025. While most businesses are subject to a 9 per cent corporate tax, MNCs meet-

ing specific criteria will face a 15 per cent rate.

However, the 'domestic top-up tax' for eligible MNCs will be 0 per cent, provided they meet the 'de minimis' threshold, meaning certain income falls below 5 per cent of total revenue or Dh5 million, whichever is lower.

Second incentive

A second incentive excludes investment entities from the 15 per cent tax, reinforcing the UAE's position as a global in-

vestment hub. Experts believe this move will attract new MNCs and boost economic activity. These policies align with 'Pillar 2' rules, which mandate a 15 per cent minimum tax for large MNCs with annual global revenues exceeding €750 million. Similar measures are in force in Kuwait, Oman, and Qatar.

Additional relief includes tax credits for high-value employment activities and a transitional tax-free period for new MNC operations.

SEE ALSO P5

Three ministries among best entities in UAE

MINISTRIES OF FOREIGN AFFAIRS, JUSTICE AND ENERGY TOP THE LIST

DUBAI

Gulf News Report

The UAE yesterday announced the top-performing and lowest-ranked government entities in its Zero Government Bureaucracy (ZGB) programme, an initiative aimed at streamlining processes and enhancing efficiency.

The Ministry of Justice, Ministry of Foreign Affairs, and Ministry of Energy and Infrastructure have been named the best-performing entities, while Emirates Post, the General Pension and Social Security Authority, and the Ministry of Sports ranked lowest in the initiative's first performance review.

His Highness Shaikh Mohammad Bin Rashid Al Maktoum, Vice-President and Prime Minister of the UAE, and Ruler of Dubai, announced the results on his X account, also naming the worst-performing entities in the initiative's first performance review.

"Government bureaucracy is the art of turning simple matters into complicated ones," Shaikh Mohammad said. "It creates systems that stifle creativity. In bureaucratic systems,



Government bureaucracy is the art of turning simple matters into complicated ones."

Shaikh Mohammad Bin Rashid Al Maktoum

procedures take precedence over results, paperwork is prioritised over service delivery, and rules are designed to discourage thinking outside the box."

He emphasised that inefficient systems — often built over years — can be dismantled with bold, decisive action. "To those not making enough effort, bad bureaucratic systems created over years can be changed with brave and fast decisions in days," he warned.

The UAE launched the ZGB programme, an ambitious initiative aimed at overhauling the current government work structure to enhance service efficiency and quality, in 2023.

The ZGB programme seeks to eliminate redundant government procedures and requirements, significantly simplifying the administrative process.

NATION

Dubai to roll out car-free, pedestrian-only 'Super Block' project | P4

BUSINESS

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